age Data Cells & Ranges

Practice Instructio

How to use this guide: Download and open your **Excel_E2_Starter** file. Work through each skill using the instructions below. Each skill shows what to do and what the result looks like. Check off each skill on the IS101 reference page.

Skills in This Guide

1. Fill Cells Using AutoFill
2. Insert and Delete Columns/Rows
3. Insert and Delete Cells
4. Format Cells
5. Merge and Unmerge Cells
6. Modify Cell Alignment
7. Format Cells Using Format Painter
8. Wrap Text Within Cells
9. Apply Conditional Formatting
10. Name Cell Ranges

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1 Fill Cells Using AutoFill

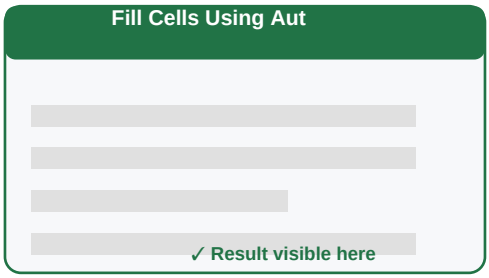
Fill handl

Your Task: The month column shows only January and February. Use AutoFill to complete through December.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the cells containing January and February.
2. Hover over the bottom-right corner until you see the fill handle (+).
3. Click and drag down to row 14 (December).
4. Release — Excel completes the series automatically.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



Cells fill with March through December. Excel recognizes the month series pattern.

2 Insert and Delete Columns/Rows

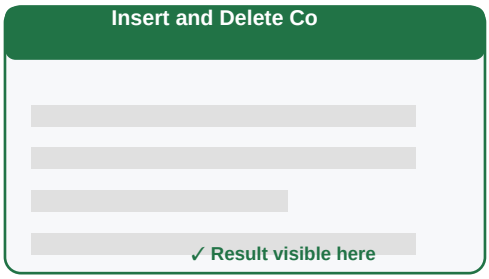
Right-clic

Your Task: Insert a new "Department" column between B and C, then delete the duplicate row.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Right-click the column C header → Insert. A new column inserts to the left.
2. Type the header: Department.
3. Find the duplicate row → right-click the row number → Delete.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



A Department column appears between B and C. The duplicate row is gone and surrounding rows shift up.

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3 Insert and Delete Cells

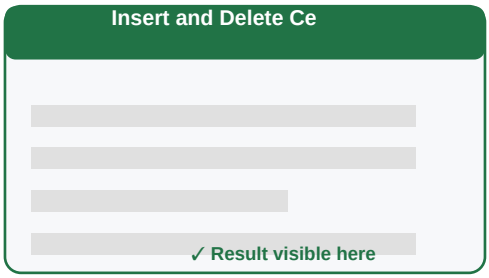
Right-clic

Your Task: Insert a cell at B6 and shift existing cells down to make room for missing data.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Right-click cell B6.
2. Choose Insert.
3. Select Shift cells down → OK.
4. A blank cell appears at B6; cells below shift down.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



A blank cell appears at B6. The data that was at B6 moves to B7 and so on.

4 Format Cells

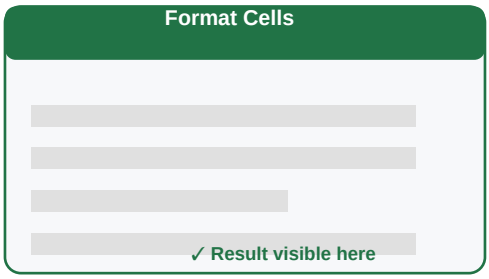
Home →

Your Task: Format the Salary column as Currency and the Start Date column as Short Date.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the Salary cells.
2. Home → Number group → $ dropdown → Currency.
3. Select the Start Date cells.
4. Home → Number group → Short Date.
5. Or press Ctrl+1 for the full Format Cells dialog.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



Salary values show with $ and two decimal places. Dates display in MM/DD/YYYY format.

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5 Merge and Unmerge Cells

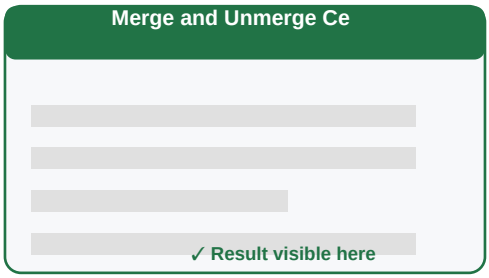
Home →

Your Task: Merge cells A1:G1 to create a centered title spanning all seven columns.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the range A1:G1.
2. Home tab → Alignment group → Merge & Center.
3. To unmerge: select the merged cell → Merge & Center again (toggles off).

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



Cells A1 through G1 become one wide cell with the title centered across all columns.

6 Modify Cell Alignment

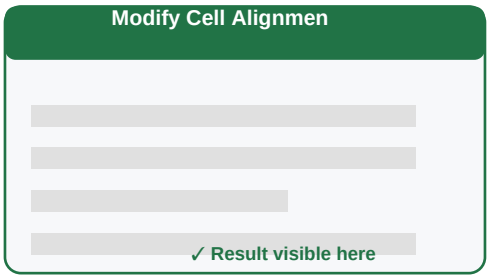
Home →

Your Task: Center the column headers and right-align the Salary and Date columns.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the header row.
2. Home → Alignment → Center and Middle Align.
3. Select the numeric columns (Salary, Dates).
4. Home → Alignment → Align Right.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



Headers are centered horizontally and vertically. Numeric columns are right-aligned (industry standard).

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7 Format Cells Using Format Painter

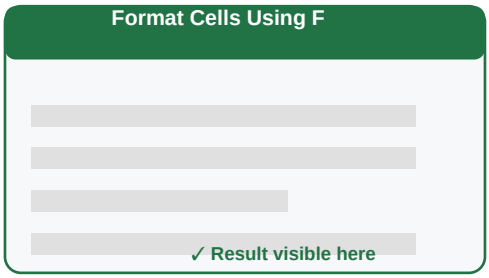
Home →

Your Task: Copy the header row formatting and apply it to the totals row at the bottom.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Click a formatted header cell.
2. Home → Clipboard → Format Painter (paintbrush icon).
3. Click and drag across the totals row to apply the formatting.
4. Double-click Format Painter to apply to multiple areas.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



The totals row now has identical formatting to the header row.

8 Wrap Text Within Cells

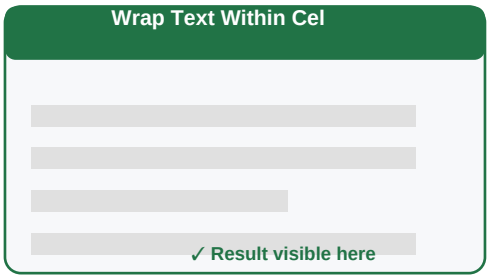
Home →

Your Task: Enable text wrapping for column A so long department names are fully visible.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the column A data cells with long text.
2. Home tab → Alignment group → Wrap Text.
3. Row heights adjust automatically to show the full text.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



Long department names wrap to multiple lines within their cells. All content is visible without widening the column.

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9 Apply Conditional Formatting

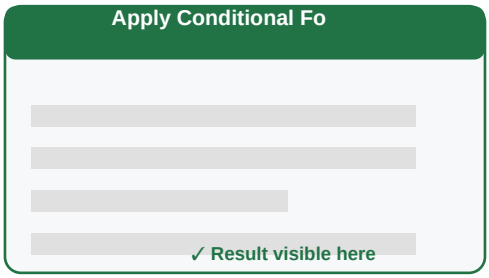
Home →

Your Task: Highlight salaries above $100,000 in green and below $55,000 in red.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the salary data cells.
2. Home → Conditional Formatting → Highlight Cells Rules → Greater Than → 100000 → Green Fill → OK.
3. Repeat: Less Than → 55000 → Red Fill with Dark Red Text → OK.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



High salaries show green fill; low salaries show red fill. Other values remain unformatted.

10 Name Cell Ranges

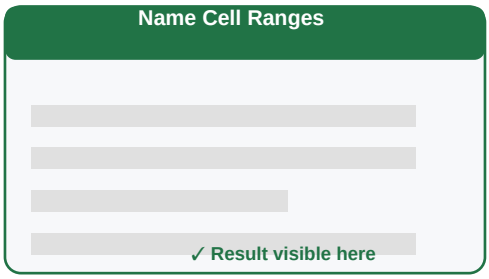
Name Bo

Your Task: Define the name "Salaries" for the salary data range so it can be used in formulas.

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

1. Select the salary data cells (D3:D17 or similar).
2. Click the Name Box at the top-left of the screen.
3. Type Salaries and press Enter.
4. Or: Formulas tab → Defined Names → Define Name.

WHAT THE RESULT LOOKS LIKE



The Name Box shows "Salaries" when that range is selected. Use =SUM(Salaries) in formulas.

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